

Question 23 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Describe training as an HRD subsystem and explain how it contributes to employee development.

Introduction

Training is a planned organisational effort to help employees learn job-related competencies. Noe and others define it as facilitating learning of competencies needed for the job. In HRD, training is one subsystem — important, but not the whole of HRD. It contributes to development when it is need-based and supported on the job.

Detailed points

- 1. Place in the HRD system.** Training receives needs from TNA and appraisal, uses design and delivery, and returns people to work where climate and bosses must support transfer. Isolated training is an event; as subsystem it is a link in a chain.
- 2. Skill, knowledge and attitude.** Contribution is at all three levels. Example: a customer officer needs product knowledge, listening skill, and an attitude of respect. Training that only lectures facts under-develops the person.
- 3. Present-job effectiveness.** When need = standard – actual, and the cause is KSA, training raises proficiency, reduces errors and raises confidence. That is immediate development of role capability.
- 4. Preparation for change and future roles.** New machines, laws, software or supervisory roles require training before people fail in public. Development here is preventive. Combined with education, it also builds conceptual ability.
- 5. Morale and employability.** Notes list higher satisfaction, motivation, lower turnover, better image. Being trained is a signal that the organisation invests in the person — a developmental message.
- 6. Socialisation.** Induction training develops understanding of culture, rules and customers. New employees become members, not only job holders.
- 7. Limits of contribution.** Training cannot fix broken processes, bad pay, or cruel bosses. Development contribution dies if transfer climate is weak. That is why it must remain a subsystem among others.
- 8. How to maximise contribution.** TNA, clear objectives, suitable methods (OJT/off-the-job/e-learning), delivery quality, boss support, and evaluation. Then training truly develops, not entertains.

Conclusion. Describe training's definition and system place, then contributions (KSA, current job, future, morale, induction) and limits. Close: training develops employees when integrated, not when it is a picnic.